

Point Set Topology

Labix

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1 Topological Spaces

1.1 Basic Definitions

Definition 1.1.1 (Topological Space)

A topological space is a pair $(X, \mathcal{T})$ where X is a set and $\mathcal{T} \subseteq \mathcal{P}(X)$ such that the following are true.

- $\emptyset, X \in \mathcal{T}$.
- Let $W \subseteq \mathcal{T}$. Then we have $\bigcup_{U \in W} U \in \mathcal{T}$.
- Let $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Let $U_1, \dots, U_n \in \mathcal{T}$. Then we have $\bigcap_{i=1}^n U_i \in \mathcal{T}$.

We call $\mathcal{T}$ the topology on X and elements of $\mathcal{T}$ are called open sets of X .

Example 1.1.2

Let $X = \{1, 2, 3, 4\}$. Let $\mathcal{T} = \{\emptyset, \{1\}, \{1, 2\}, \{1, 3\}, \{1, 2, 3\}, X\}$. Then $(X, \mathcal{T})$ is a topological space.

Definition 1.1.3 (Closed Sets)

A subset A of a topological space X is said to be closed if $X \setminus A$ is open.

Beware that this definition means that sets which are both open and closed could exist. They are not binary and should not be treated as such. As taking complements of sets allows De Morgans' law to be applied with unions and intersection, we have the following so called alternative definition of a topological space.

Proposition 1.1.4

- Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space.
- X and $\emptyset$ is closed
 - If $U_1, \dots, U_n$ are closed then $\bigcup_{k=1}^n U_k$ is closed
 - If $\{U_i : i \in I\}$ is closed for all i then $\bigcap_{i \in I} U_i$ is closed

Proof

- Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space.
- $X, \emptyset$ are open thus $\emptyset, X$ are closed
 - $X \setminus U_1, \dots, X \setminus U_n$ are open thus $\bigcap_{k=1}^n (X \setminus U_k) = X \setminus \bigcup_{k=1}^n U_k$ is open and $\bigcup_{k=1}^n U_k$ is closed
 - $\{X \setminus U_i : i \in I\}$ are open sets thus $\bigcup_{i \in I} (X \setminus U_i) = X \setminus \bigcap_{i \in I} U_i$ is open and $\bigcap_{i \in I} U_i$ is closed

■

Definition 1.1.5 (Basis)

Let X be a set. A collection of sets $\mathcal{B} \subseteq \mathcal{P}(X)$ is called a basis on X if

- For every $x \in X$, there exists $B \in \mathcal{B}$ such that $x \in B$, meaning $\bigcup_{B \in \mathcal{B}} B = X$
- For every $B_1, B_2 \in \mathcal{B}$, for every $x \in B_1 \cap B_2$, there exists $B \in \mathcal{B}$ such that $x \in B \subseteq B_1 \cap B_2$

Similar to a vector space, we allow a smaller collection of open sets to "generate" the entire topology. This allows us to simply define the topology based on some smaller collection of open sets instead of having to write out every single open set in the topology. We prove this fact with the below proposition.

Proposition 1.1.6

Let X be a set and $\mathcal{B}$ be a basis on X . Then

$$\mathcal{T}_{\mathcal{B}} = \left\{ \bigcup_{X \in \mathcal{C}} X : \mathcal{C} \subseteq \mathcal{B} \right\}$$

is a topology of X generated by $\mathcal{B}$.

Proof We prove that $\mathcal{T}_{\mathcal{B}}$ satisfies the three definitions of a topology. Note that $\emptyset \subseteq \mathcal{B}$ and $\bigcup_{X \in \emptyset} X = \emptyset$ thus $\emptyset \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathcal{B}}$. Also $\bigcup_{B \in \mathcal{B}} B = X$. Now let $\{V_i : i \in I\} \subseteq \mathcal{T}_{\mathcal{B}}$. $V_i \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathcal{B}}$ means that there

exists some $C_i \in \mathcal{B}$ such that $\bigcup_{X \in C_i} X = V_i$. Now consider $\bigcup_{i \in I} \bigcup_{X \in C_i} X$.

$$\bigcup_{i \in I} \bigcup_{X \in C_i} X = \bigcup_{X \in \bigcup_{i \in I} C_i} X$$

However, $\bigcup_{i \in I} C_i \subseteq \mathcal{B}$ thus we are done. Finally, we prove that for $U, V \in \mathcal{T}_\mathcal{B}$, $U \cap V \in \mathcal{T}_\mathcal{B}$. Let

$$U = \bigcup_{X \in \mathcal{A}} X$$

and

$$V = \bigcup_{X \in \mathcal{C}} X$$

We have that

$$U \cap V = \bigcup \{A \cap C : A \in \mathcal{A}, C \in \mathcal{C}\}$$

Now consider $A \cap C$ for any $A \in \mathcal{A}$ and $C \in \mathcal{C}$. Let $x \in A \cap C$. Since $\mathcal{B}$ is a basis, there exists $B_x \in \mathcal{B}$ such that $x \in B_x \subset A \cap C$. Since $x \in A \cap C$ implies $x \in B_x$,

$$A \cap C \subset \bigcup_{x \in A \cap C} B_x$$

But also, $B_x \subset A \cap C$ thus

$$\bigcup_{x \in A \cap C} B_x \subset A \cap C$$

Thus

$$\bigcup_{x \in A \cap C} B_x = A \cap C$$

Since $B_x \in \mathcal{B}$ for all x , we have $A \cap C \in \mathcal{T}_\mathcal{B}$ and since we prove property 2 of definition of a topology, we have $U \cap V = \bigcup \{A \cap C : A \in \mathcal{A}, C \in \mathcal{C}\} \subset \mathcal{T}_\mathcal{B}$ ■

Aside from the concept of a basis which generates a topology, sub basis also generates a topology.

Definition 1.1.7 (Sub Basis) A sub basis for a topology $\mathcal{T}$ on T is a collection $\mathcal{B} \subset \mathcal{T}$ such that every set $\mathcal{T}$ is a union of finite intersections of sets from $\mathcal{B}$.

Comparing the two notions of basis in a topology, a basis generates the topology by creating unions of sets while a sub basis generates a topology using finite intersections. In practice both are useful in their respectful places. Often sub basis consists of less sets, but requires you to think about finite intersections which may or may not be harder depending on the situation.

Proposition 1.1.8 If $\mathcal{B}$ is any collection of subsets of a set X , and $\bigcup_{B \in \mathcal{B}} B = X$ then there exists a unique topology $\mathcal{T}$ on X with sub basis $\mathcal{B}$. In particular,

$$\mathcal{T} = \{\text{Union of finite intersections of sets of } \mathcal{B}\}$$

Proof Let $\mathcal{B}$ be a sub basis of a topology $\mathcal{T}$. Then by definition, since every $U \in \mathcal{T}$ is a finite intersection of sets from $\mathcal{B}$, the collection of finite intersections precisely form a basis for $\mathcal{T}$. ■

1.2 Closure, Interior and Boundary

We give some more names to some more random sets.

Definition 1.2.1 (Neighbourhood) A neighbourhood of $x \in X$ a topological space is a set $U \subset X$ such that $x \in B \subset U$ for some $B \in \mathcal{T}$.

The neighbourhood acts like the open ball in metric spaces. Since we have no open balls in a topological

space, this acts like the open ball for more potential structures such as limits. In fact the open balls are stricter than open neighbourhoods in a metric space, but they are mostly interchangeable.

Also, the B seems quite random in the definition, but is in fact necessary. There are some topological spaces where sets like $\{x\}$ does not exist. To talk about the surrounding of x , we must somehow quantify it. Therefore we first use some set that contains x , then surround it with another set.

In the remainder of the section, three operations will be given to sets in a topological space. They each have unique properties which will soon prove itself useful.

Definition 1.2.2 (Closure) Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space. Let $A \subset X$. Define the closure of A , denoted $\overline{A}$ to be the intersection of all closed subsets of X that contain A , meaning

$$\overline{A} = \bigcap_{\substack{A \subseteq U \subseteq X \\ U \text{ is closed}}} U$$

You can think of closure as the boundary of a set plus the set itself. It sort of completes the set by closing it. Inherently it implies that $\overline{A}$ is the smallest closed set containing A . Indeed if there were an even smaller closed set F between A and $\overline{A}$, then it should be contained in the intersection as well, which means that $\overline{A} \subset F$, a contradiction of the construction of F . We dedicate the next few theorems in establishing properties of closure.

Lemma 1.2.3 Let X be a topological space. Let $A \subset X$. Then $\overline{A}$ is closed.

Proof $\overline{A}$ is necessarily closed since it is the intersection of closed subsets. ■

Closed sets are special in the sense that limits of convergence sequences will be contained in these sets (in particularly nice spaces), as we will see later, by taking the closure of a set, we are implicitly containing all limits of sequences into the original set. And as you have already seen, closed intervals in real analysis give rise to many interesting theorems such as Bolzano-Weierstrass theorem as well as a bunch of continuity theorems that actually depend on the fact that its domain is a closed set.

Proposition 1.2.4 Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space. Let $A \subset X$. A is closed if and only if $\overline{A} = A$.

Proof First let A be closed. Then A is the smallest subset of X that contains A . Thus the intersection of all closed subsets larger than A is equal to A . Thus $\overline{A} = A$. Suppose that $\overline{A} = A$. Then $\overline{A}$ is proved to be closed already. ■

That gives us a neat condition to show that whether a set is closed instead of having to show that its complement is open. However, this privilege must wait until we define the boundary of a set.

Proposition 1.2.5 Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space. Let $A, B \subset X$. Then

- $\overline{\overline{A}} = \overline{A}$
- $A \subseteq \overline{A}$
- $A \subseteq B \implies \overline{A} \subseteq \overline{B}$
- $\overline{A \cup B} = \overline{A} \cup \overline{B}$

Proof Let X be a topological space and $A \subset X$.

- Immediate from the above two proposition.
- The closure is defined by taking intersection of subsets U of X where $A \subseteq U$. Thus necessarily A is also a subset of the intersection of those subsets.
- Suppose that $A \subseteq B$. Then by definition any closed set containing B must contain A thus

$$\bigcap_{\substack{A \subseteq U \subseteq X \\ U \text{ is closed}}} U \subseteq \bigcap_{\substack{B \subseteq U \subseteq X \\ U \text{ is closed}}} U$$

and we are done.

- We first prove that $\overline{A \cup B} \subseteq \overline{A} \cup \overline{B}$. Notice that $\overline{A \cup B}$ is closed and contains A and B . By definition, $\overline{A \cup B}$ is the smallest closed set containing A and B thus any closed set containing A and B must contain $\overline{A \cup B}$.

Now we prove the opposite inclusion. Notice that since $A, B \subseteq A \cup B$, we have that $\overline{A}, \overline{B} \subseteq \overline{A \cup B}$ thus $\overline{A} \cup \overline{B} \subseteq \overline{A \cup B}$ and we are done. ■

Notice that $\overline{A \cap B} = \overline{A} \cap \overline{B}$ is generally wrong. A typical counter example would be two unit squares not including boundaries centered at $(0.5, 0)$ and $(-0.5, 0)$ respectively. Since they don't include their boundaries their intersection is empty, and taking closure of the empty set is the empty set. But if you take closure before you intersect them, their boundaries will meet and taking intersections would give the line segment between $(0, 0.5)$ and $(0, -0.5)$.

We finish the topic of closure with the following characterization of closure.

Theorem 1.2.6 Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space, let $A \subset X$. Then

$$\overline{A} = \{x \in X \mid \forall U \in \mathcal{T} \text{ with } x \in U, U \cap A \neq \emptyset\}$$

Proof Let $x \in \overline{A}$. Suppose for a contradiction that there exists an open set U containing x such that $U \cap A = \emptyset$. Then $X \setminus U$ does not contain x and is closed. Then $\overline{A} \subseteq X \setminus U$ which is a contradiction since $x \in \overline{A}$ but $x \notin X \setminus U$.

Now suppose that $x \in X$ such that for all open sets U , $U \cap A \neq \emptyset$. Suppose for a contradiction that $x \notin \overline{A}$. Then there exists a closed set F such that $x \notin F$ and $A \subseteq F$. Then $X \setminus F$ is open and contains x but $X \setminus F \cap A = \emptyset$ thus this is a contradiction. ■

If we can "complete" a set into its closed form by closure, we could also dig out the contents and leave out its boundary (if it has one) with interior.

Definition 1.2.7 (Interior) Let A be a subset of a topological space $(X, \mathcal{T})$. We say that $x \in A$ is an interior point of A if there exists an open set U such that $x \in U \subset A$. Denote the set of all interior points of A by A° . Then

$$A^\circ = \{x \in A \mid \exists U \in \mathcal{T}, x \in U \subset A\}$$

We have the following equivalent characterization of interiors.

Proposition 1.2.8 Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space and $A \subset X$. Then A° is the union of all open sets of X contained in A . In other words,

$$A^\circ = \bigcup_{\substack{U \subset A \\ U \text{ is open}}} U$$

Proof Let $x \in \bigcup_{\substack{U \subset A \\ U \text{ is open}}} U$. Then $x \in U$ for some open set $U \subset A$. Thus $\bigcup_{\substack{U \subset A \\ U \text{ is open}}} U \subseteq A^\circ$.

Let $x \in A^\circ$. Then there exists $U \in \mathcal{T}$ such that $x \in U \subset A$ with U open. Thus $x \in \bigcup_{\substack{U \subset A \\ U \text{ is open}}} U$ and we are done. ■

Similar to the observation in closure, from this definition we see that A° is the largest open set contained in A because if there were an even larger set, then taking union of that set will imply that $A^\circ \subset A^\circ \cup U \subset A$ which means that $A^\circ \cup U$ should be contained in A° , a contradiction.

Proposition 1.2.9 Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space and $A \subset X$. Then A is open if and only if $A = A^\circ$.

Proof Let A be open. Since A is open and A is the largest subset of A , by the equivalent characterization $A^\circ = A$ thus we are done.

Let $A^\circ = A$. Then A is the union of open subsets thus A is also open. ■

The following lemma is already implicitly used above but for completeness I will state it here.

Lemma 1.2.10 Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space and $A \subset X$. Then A° is open.

Proof A° is a union of open sets. ■

If taking closure has the useful property that all its limits will be included (in metric spaces), we will soon see, and as I have already hinted, that open sets provide a notion of how close two points are in a topological space. Open sets also serve as the core part of a notion in topological spaces such as continuity and connectedness as we will see later. It is therefore often useful to consider interiors of a set if wanted to do a prove with open sets.

Proposition 1.2.11 Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space. Let $A, B \subset X$. Then

- $(A^\circ)^\circ = A^\circ$
- $A^\circ \subseteq A$
- $A \subseteq B \implies A^\circ \subseteq B^\circ$
- $(A \cap B)^\circ = A^\circ \cap B^\circ$

Proof Let $A, B \subset X$.

- Immediate from the above two propositions
- Direct from the definition
- Every open set that A contains B must also contain. Thus $x \in A^\circ$ implies there exists U open such that $x \in U \subset A \subset B$ which implies $x \in B^\circ$.
- We first prove that $(A \cap B)^\circ \subseteq A^\circ \cap B^\circ$. Note that $A \cap B \subseteq A, B$, taking the interior gives $(A \cap B)^\circ \subseteq A^\circ, B^\circ$. Thus $(A \cap B)^\circ \subseteq A^\circ \cap B^\circ$.
Now we prove the opposite inclusion. Notice that $A^\circ \cap B^\circ$ is open and contains $A \cap B$. Since $(A \cap B)^\circ$ is the largest open set contained in $A \cap B$. It should also contain $A^\circ \cap B^\circ$ thus we are done. ■

In general, $(A \cup B)^\circ \neq A^\circ \cup B^\circ$. Try and consider the two unit squares again but this time include their boundaries.

Finally, we relate the two operations by the following rule.

Proposition 1.2.12 Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space. Let $A \subset X$. Then

$$A^\circ = X \setminus \overline{(X \setminus A)} \text{ and } \overline{A} = X \setminus (X \setminus A)^\circ$$

Proof Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space and $A \subset X$.

- We have that

$$X \setminus \bigcup_{\substack{U \subset A \\ U \text{ is open}}} U = \bigcap_{\substack{U \subset A \\ U \text{ is open}}} X \setminus U$$

Closures and interiors are like opposite operations. However from the above we can see that they are

not opposite in the sense of set complements.

Definition 1.2.13 (Boundary) Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space and $A \subset X$. x is a boundary point of A if for every neighbourhood U of x , $U \cap A \neq \emptyset$ and $U \cap X \setminus A \neq \emptyset$. Denote the set of all boundary points by ∂A .

If you are able to concretely graspe the meaning of interiors and closures, you will see that they are very suitably names, especially when considering sets in $\mathbb{R}^n$. Boundary is no exception. These proposition will seem very trivial once the image is well produced in the back of your head.

Proposition 1.2.14 Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space and $A \subseteq X$. Then

- $\partial A = \overline{A} \cap \overline{X \setminus A}$
- $\overline{A} = A \cup \partial A$
- $\partial A = \overline{A} \setminus A^\circ$

Proof

- Let $x \in \partial A$. Then for every open neighbourhood U of x , $U \cap A \neq \emptyset$ implies that $x \in \overline{A}$ and $U \cap (X \setminus A) \neq \emptyset$ implies that $x \in \overline{X \setminus A}$.
The above statements can all be reversed thus we are done.
- Let $x \in \overline{A}$. Then for every open neighbourhood U of x , $U \cap A \neq \emptyset$. This has two cases, either $U \subseteq A$ or $U \not\subseteq A$. For the first case, $x \in U \subseteq A$ then we are done. For the latter case assume that $x \notin U \cap A$. Then $x \in U \cap X \setminus A \neq \emptyset$. This implies that $U \in \partial A$ thus we are done.
Now suppose that $x \in A \cup \partial A$. If $x \in A$, we are done. Suppose that $x \in \partial A$. Then for every open set U containing x , $U \cap A \neq \emptyset$. But this is the definition of $x \in \overline{A}$ thus we are done.
- Let $x \in \partial A$, by the above, we know that $\partial A \subseteq \overline{A}$. We need to show that $x \notin A^\circ$. Suppose for a contradiction that $x \in A^\circ$. Then there exists an open set U containing x such that $x \in U \subseteq A$. But this is a contradiction of the definition of boundary since we require that $U \cap X \setminus A \neq \emptyset$ for every open set U .
Now suppose that $x \in \overline{A} \setminus A^\circ$. Then since $x \in \overline{A}$, every open set U containing x has the property that $U \cap A \neq \emptyset$. Also $x \notin A^\circ$ implies that if U is open and contains x , then $U \not\subseteq A$ which implies that $U \cap X \setminus A \neq \emptyset$. Then this is precisely the definition of boundary thus $x \in \partial A$ thus we are done.

We now give a name to a special type of points, where will see the reasoning later.

Definition 1.2.15 (Limit Points) Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space and $A \subset X$. x is a limit point of A if every neighbourhood of x intersects with $A \setminus \{x\}$. Meaning if U is a neighbourhood of x , then

$$U \cap A \setminus \{x\} \neq \emptyset$$

A point in A that is not a limit point is called an isolated point.

Note that limit points does not necessarily lie inside the set itself.

Proposition 1.2.16 Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space and $A \subset X$. Then

$$\overline{A} = A \cup \{\text{Limit points of } A\}$$

The final type of sets are called dense sets, which accurately as its name indicates, it dictates the sparse-ness of a subset with respect to its topological space.

Definition 1.2.17 (Dense Sets) Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space. Let $D \subseteq X$. D is said to be dense if $\overline{D} = X$

Lemma 1.2.18 Every set is dense in and of itself.

Proof Let X be a topological space. Then X is trivially closed thus $\overline{X} = X$. ■

Unfortunately this lemma does not give much insight as to why this is the case. A good example would be that $\mathbb{Q}$ is dense in $\mathbb{Q}$ and also dense in $\mathbb{R}$. The meaning of dense here is something we have already seen in real analysis. We already know that rational numbers are dense in the sense that there exists a countably amount of rational numbers between any two. It is also dense in $\mathbb{R}$ because there are an countable number of real numbers between any two rational numbers. (In fact there should be an infinite amount instead of countably infinite but we have yet to see this result).

Another way to think about this is that since I have secretly told you that taking closure will include the limit points of the original set, we know that every irrational number can be approximated by a sequence of rational numbers. Thus every real number is a limit of some sequence in $\mathbb{Q}$, which gives the name dense its meaning.

Proposition 1.2.19 Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space. D is dense if and only if for all non-empty $U \subset X$, $D \cap U \neq \emptyset$.

Definition 1.2.20 (Separable Space) A topological space X is said to be separable if it has a countably dense subset.

1.3 Continuity and Homeomorphism

Definition 1.3.1 (Continuity) Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ and $(Y, \mathcal{U})$ be topological spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a function. We say that f is continuous if $f^{-1}(U) \in \mathcal{T}$ for every $U \in \mathcal{U}$.

Proposition 1.3.2

Let X, Y be topological spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a function. Then the following are true.

- f is continuous.
- For any basis $\mathcal{B}$ of Y , we have $f^{-1}(U)$ is open for all $U \in \mathcal{B}$.
- For any subbasis $\mathcal{S}$ of Y , we have $f^{-1}(U)$ is open for all $U \in \mathcal{S}$.
- For all closed set $C \subseteq Y$, we have $f^{-1}(C)$ is closed.
- For every $A \subseteq X$, we have $f(\overline{A}) \subseteq \overline{f(A)}$

Proposition 1.3.3

Let X, Y, Z be topological spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ and $g : Y \rightarrow Z$ be continuous functions. Then $g \circ f$ is continuous.

Definition 1.3.4 (Homeomorphism) Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ and $(Y, \mathcal{U})$ be topological spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a function. We say that f is a homeomorphism if the following are true.

- f is bijective.
- f and f^{-1} are continuous.

2 New Topologies from Old

2.1 Subspace Topologies

Definition 2.1.1 (Subspace Topology)

Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space. Let $Y \subseteq X$ be a subset. Define the subspace topology on Y to be

$$\mathcal{T}_Y = \{U \cap Y \mid U \in \mathcal{T}\}$$

Proposition 2.1.2

Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space. Let $Y \subseteq X$ be a subset. Then the following are true regarding the subspace topology on Y .

- $(Y, \mathcal{T}_Y)$ is a subspace of X .
- The collection

$$\mathcal{B}_Y = \{B \cap Y \mid B \in \mathcal{B}\}$$

forms a basis of $(Y, \mathcal{T}_Y)$.

Proof

Trivially, $\emptyset$ and Y are in $\mathcal{T}_Y$. Now let $\{A_i \mid i \in I\} \subseteq \mathcal{T}_Y$. Then

$$\bigcup_{i \in I} A_i = \bigcup_{i \in I} (U_i \cap Y) = \left(\bigcup_{i \in I} U_i \right) \cap Y$$

and since X is a topological space, $V = \bigcup_{i \in I} U_i \in \mathcal{T}$ and thus $V \cap Y \in \mathcal{T}_Y$ and we have proved the second property.

Let $A, B \in \mathcal{T}_Y$. Then

$$A \cap B = (U_A \cap Y) \cap (U_B \cap Y) = (U_A \cap U_B) \cap Y \in \mathcal{T}_Y$$

thus we are done.

Let $y \in Y$. Then there exists $B \in \mathcal{B}$ such that $y \in B$. Then $B \cap Y \in \mathcal{B}_Y$ and $y \in B \cap Y$ and the first property is proven.

Let $B_1, B_2 \in \mathcal{B}_Y$. Then there exists $A_1, A_2 \in \mathcal{B}$ such that $B_1 = A_1 \cap Y$ and $B_2 = A_2 \cap Y$. Let $y \in B_1 \cap B_2 = A_1 \cap A_2 \cap Y$. By definition of a basis there exists $A \in \mathcal{B}$ such that $y \in A \subset A_1 \cap A_2$. Then $y \in A \cap Y \subset B_1 \cap B_2$ and $A \cap Y \in \mathcal{B}_Y$. Thus we are done. ■

Proposition 2.1.3

Let X be a topological space. Let $Y \subseteq X$ be a subspace of X . Let $U \subseteq Y$ be a subset. Then the following are true.

- If U is open in Y and Y is open in X , then U is open in X .
- The subspace topology of U from Y is the same as the subspace topology of U from X .
- $\overline{U}_Y = Y \cap \overline{U}_X$, where $\overline{Z}_Y$ is the closure of Z in Y .

Lemma 2.1.4 (Pasting Lemma) Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ and $(Y, \mathcal{U})$ be topological spaces. Let $A, B \subset X$, either both open or both closed, such that $X = A \cup B$ and both are subspaces of X . Let $f : A \rightarrow Y$ and $g : B \rightarrow Y$ be continuous functions that agree on $A \cap B$. Define $h : X \rightarrow Y$ by

$$h(x) = \begin{cases} f(x) & \text{if } x \in A \\ g(x) & \text{if } x \in B \end{cases}$$

Then h is continuous.

Proof Problem arises when an open set that is part of both A and B is considered. Otherwise they are continuous in its own way. ■

2.2 Product Topology

Definition 2.2.1 (Product Topology)

Let $(X, \mathcal{T}_X)$ and $(Y, \mathcal{T}_Y)$ be topological spaces. Define the product topology on $X \times Y$ to be the topology generated by the basis

$$\{U \times V \mid U \in \mathcal{T}_X, V \in \mathcal{T}_Y\}$$

Proposition 2.2.2

Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ and $(Y, \mathcal{U})$ be topological spaces. Let $\mathcal{B}_X$ and $\mathcal{B}_Y$ be bases on X and Y that generate $\mathcal{T}$ and $\mathcal{U}$, respectively. Then

$$\mathcal{B} = \{U \times V \mid U \in \mathcal{B}_X, V \in \mathcal{B}_Y\}$$

is a basis for the product topology on $X \times Y$.

Proposition 2.2.3 Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ and $(Y, \mathcal{U})$ be topological spaces. Let $x \in X$. Define a map $f : Y \rightarrow X \times Y$ by $f(y) = (x, y)$ for all $y \in Y$. Then f is a homeomorphism onto its image.

Proof The subspace $\{x\} \cup Y$ has open sets of the form $\emptyset \times U$ or $\{x\} \times U$ for $U \in \mathcal{U}$. Then f is continuous since $f^{-1}(\{x\} \cup U) = U$ and $f^{-1}(\emptyset \cup U) = \emptyset$. f is bijective since they have the same cardinality. The inverse map is also continuous since $f(U) = \{x\} \times U$ is open for open sets U . ■

Proposition 2.2.4 (Universal Property of Product Spaces) Let $(X, \mathcal{T}_X)$ and $(Y, \mathcal{T}_Y)$ be topological spaces. Then the product space $X \times Y$ satisfies the following universal property.

For any topological space $(Z, \mathcal{T}_Z)$ and continuous functions $f : Z \rightarrow X$ and $g : Z \rightarrow Y$, there exists a unique continuous function $u : Z \rightarrow X \times Y$ such that the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} Z & \xrightarrow{f} & X \\ \downarrow g & \searrow \exists! u & \downarrow \text{proj}_Y \\ & X \times Y & \xrightarrow{\text{proj}_X} X \\ & \downarrow \text{proj}_Y & \\ & Y & \end{array}$$

where $\text{proj}_X : X \times Y \rightarrow X$ is the function defined by $\text{proj}(x, y) = x$ and vice versa for proj_Y .

Corollary 2.2.5

Let X, Y, Z be topological spaces. Suppose that $f : Z \rightarrow X \times Y$ is a function. Then f is continuous if and only if $\text{proj}_X \circ f : Z \rightarrow X$ and $\text{proj}_Y \circ f : Z \rightarrow Y$ are continuous.

2.3 Quotient Topology

Definition 2.3.1 (Quotient Topology)

Let X be a topological space. Let $\sim$ be an equivalence relation on X and write $\pi : X \rightarrow X/\sim$ the quotient map of sets. Define a topology on $X/\sim$ as follows. We say that $U \subseteq X/\sim$ is open if and only if $\pi^{-1}(U)$ is open in X .

One can perform quotient on subspaces as follows. For $U \subseteq X$ a subset, we define an equivalence relation on X by declaring that $x \sim y$ if and only if $x, y \in U$. Then we write the quotient space as

$$\frac{X}{U}$$

In particular, this has the effect of considering U as a single point in X .

Notice that the function $\pi : X \rightarrow X/\sim$ in the definition becomes continuous by definition.

Proposition 2.3.2 (Universal Property of Quotient Spaces) Let X be a topological space and $\sim$ an equivalence relation on X . Then the quotient space $X/\sim$ satisfy the following universal property.

For any topological space Y and a map $f : X \rightarrow Y$ such that $f(x) = f(y)$ for all $x \sim y$, then there exists a unique map $u : X/\sim \rightarrow Y$ such that the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X & \xrightarrow{\pi} & X/\sim \\ & \searrow f & \downarrow \exists! u \\ & & Y \end{array}$$

3 Separation Axioms

3.1 Convergence and T_0, T_1, T_2 Spaces

Definition 3.1.1 (Convergence) Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space. A sequence $\{x_n\}_{n=1}^{\infty}$ is said to converge to a point $x \in X$ if for every open set U containing x , there is an $N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $x_n \in U$ for all $n > N$. In this case we write

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} x_n = x$$

Proposition 3.1.2 Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space. Let $A \subseteq X$. Let $\{a_n\} \subset A$ be a sequence. If $a_n \rightarrow a$ then $a \in \overline{A}$.

Definition 3.1.3 (Kolmogorov T_0 Space) Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space. It is said to be T_0 if for any pair of distinct points $x, y \in X$, there exists an open set U that contains one of them and not the other.

Unfortunately, sequences in T_0 spaces are way too wild for us to perform analysis. They can virtually converge to any other point in the space. We need stronger separation axioms so that points in the space can be more distinctly presented. Even constant sequences can converge to different values!

Definition 3.1.4 (Frechet T_1 Space) Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space. It is said to be T_1 if there exists open sets U, V such that U contains x but not y and V contains y but not x .

This is better. Constant sequences now have unique convergent values. But still, the same cannot be said to general sequences. We need yet another stronger separation axiom. But before we look at T_2 , we have some equivalent characterizations of T_1 spaces.

Proposition 3.1.5 Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space. The following are equivalent.

- $(X, \mathcal{T})$ is T_1
- For every $x \in X$, $\{x\}$ is closed
- Every finite subset of X is closed.
- For every subset $A \subset X$, $A = \bigcap \{U \subset X : U \text{ is open and } A \subset U\}$

Now comes the main space of study.

Definition 3.1.6 (Hausdorff T_2 Space) Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space. It is said to be T_2 if for every pair of distinct points $x, y \in X$, there exists open sets U, V such that $U \cap V = \emptyset$ and $x \in U$ and $y \in V$.

Most analysis and well behaved spaces lie under this category. The reason is given by the following theorem.

Theorem 3.1.7 Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a Hausdorff space. Then every sequence in X converges to at most one point.

Proof Let $x_n \rightarrow x$ and $x_n \rightarrow y$ with $x \neq y$. Since X is Hausdorff there exists open sets U, V such that $x \in U$, $y \in V$ and $U \cap V = \emptyset$. By definition of convergence, there exists $N_1 \geq 1$ and $N_2 \geq 1$ such that $x_n \in U$ for all $n \geq N_1$ and $x_n \in V$ for all $n \geq N_2$. This is a contradiction since $x \in U \cup V$ when $n \geq \max(N_1, N_2)$ but $U \cap V = \emptyset$. ■

Finally, sequences can converge uniquely. If you recall, notions such as continuity in real analysis are based on sequences. Therefore we really need sequences to be well behaved so that our foundations are solid. In fact, most of the more fun and useful spaces are Hausdorff. Therefore we paid less attention to T_0 and T_1 spaces. However, in order for sequences to capture key information of spaces, we need a bit more restrictions.

3.2 First Countability and Hausdorff

Definition 3.2.1 (Local Basis) Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space. Let $x \in X$. A local basis at x is a collection of open sets $\mathcal{B}_x \subseteq \mathcal{T}$ following

- $x \in B$ for all $B \in \mathcal{B}_x$
- For any open set U containing x , there exists $B \in \mathcal{B}_x$ such that $B \subseteq U$

Definition 3.2.2 (First Countable) Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space. It is first countable if every point in X has a countable local basis

Proposition 3.2.3 Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a first countable topological space. Then for all $x \in X$, there exists a local basis $\mathcal{B}_x = \{B_n : n \in \mathbb{N}\}$ such that $B_1 \supseteq B_2 \supseteq B_3 \supseteq \dots$

With the above proposition, we can reverse the previous proposition stating that convergent values lie inside the closure.

Proposition 3.2.4 Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a first countable topological space. Let $A \subseteq X$. Then $x \in \bar{A}$ if and only if there is a sequence of elements of A converging to x .

The following is a partial converse to the unique limit point proposition that involves first countability.

Proposition 3.2.5 Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a first countable topological space. If every convergent sequence has a unique limit point, then it is Hausdorff.

3.3 T_3 Spaces and Regularity

Definition 3.3.1 (Regular Space) A topological space $(X, \mathcal{T})$ is said to be regular if for any $x \in X$ and any closed set C not containing x , there are disjoint open sets U, V such that $x \in U$ and $C \subset V$

Definition 3.3.2 (T_3 Space) A topological space is said to be T_3 if it is T_1 and regular.

Proposition 3.3.3 Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be regular. Then $(X, \mathcal{T})$ is T_0 if and only if it is T_1 if and only if it is T_2 .

Proposition 3.3.4 A topological space $(X, \mathcal{T})$ is regular if and only if for every point $x \in X$ and every open set U containing x , there is an open set V such that $x \in V \subseteq \bar{V} \subseteq U$

Proposition 3.3.5

Let X be a topological space. Let $Y \subseteq X$ be a subspace. Then the following are true.

- If X is regular, then Y is regular.
- If X is T_3 , then Y is T_3 .

Proposition 3.3.6

Let X, Y be topological spaces. Then the following are true.

- If X, Y are regular, then $X \times Y$ is regular.
- If X, Y are T_3 , then $X \times Y$ is T_3 .

3.4 T_4 Spaces and Normality

Definition 3.4.1 (Normal Spaces) A topological space $(X, \mathcal{T})$ is said to be normal if for any two disjoint, non-empty, closed subsets $C, D \subseteq X$, there are disjoint open sets U and V containing C and D respectively.

Definition 3.4.2 (T_4 Spaces) A topological space $(X, \mathcal{T})$ is said to be T_4 if it is T_1 and normal.

Proposition 3.4.3 A topological space $(X, \mathcal{T})$ is normal if and only if for every open set U and every closed set $C \subset U$, there exists an open set V such that $C \subseteq V \subseteq \overline{V} \subseteq U$

Proposition 3.4.4

Let X be a topological space. If X is regular and second countable, then X is normal.

4 Relation to Metric Spaces

4.1 The Metric Topology

Definition 4.1.1 (Metric Topology) Let (X, d) be a metric space. The metric topology on X is the topology on X generated by

$$\mathcal{B}_d = \{B(x_0, r) \mid x_0 \in X, r \in \mathbb{R}^+\}$$

Proposition 4.1.2 Let (X, d) be a metric space. Then $(X, \mathcal{B}_d)$ is Hausdorff.

Proposition 4.1.3

Let X, Y be metric spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a function. Then f is continuous as a function between metric spaces if and only if it is continuous as a function between topological spaces.

Proposition 4.1.4

Let (X, d) be a metric space. Let $U \subseteq X$ be a subset. Then $(U, d|_{U \times U})$ is a metric space if and only if U is open.

4.2 Topologically Equivalent Norms

Let k be a field. Let V be a vector space over k . Recall that a norm on V is a function $\|\cdot\| : V \rightarrow k$ satisfying the following rules:

- $\|x\| \geq 0$ with equality if and only if $x = 0$.
- $\|\lambda x\| = |\lambda| \|x\|$ for any $\lambda \in k$ and $x \in V$.
- $\|x + y\| \leq \|x\| + \|y\|$ for all $x, y \in V$.

Definition 4.2.1 (The Induced Metric from Norms)

Let $(V, \|\cdot\|)$ be a normed vector space over $\mathbb{R}$. Define the induced metric to be the function $d : V \times V \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ given by

$$d(x, y) = \|x - y\|$$

Definition 4.2.2 (Equivalent Norms)

Let k be a field. Let V be a vector space over k . Let $\|\cdot\|_1$ and $\|\cdot\|_2$ be two norms on V . We say that the two norms are equivalent if there exists $c_1, c_2 \in k$ such that

$$c_1 \|x\|_1 \leq \|x\|_2 \leq c_2 \|x\|_1$$

for all $x \in V$.

Proposition 4.2.3

Let k be a field. Let V be a vector space over k . Let $\|\cdot\|_1$ and $\|\cdot\|_2$ be two norms on V . Then $\|\cdot\|_1$ and $\|\cdot\|_2$ are equivalent if and only if the induced metric topologies are equal.

Proposition 4.2.4

Let k be a field. Let V be a vector space over k . Then all norms on V are equivalent.

4.3 Completion

The goal of this section is to attempt to complete a metric space by adding in the missing limits of a metric space.

Definition 4.3.1 (Space of Bounded Real Functions)

Let X be a topological space. Define the set of bounded real functions of X to be

$$B(X) = \{f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \mid |f| \leq M \text{ for some } M \in \mathbb{R}\}$$

Definition 4.3.2 (The Supremum Norm)

Let X be a topological space. Define the supremum norm on $B(X)$ by the formula

$$\|f\|_\infty = \sup_{x \in X} |f(x)|$$

Lemma 4.3.3

Let X be a topological space. Then $(B(X), \|\cdot\|_\infty)$ is a normed vector space.

Proposition 4.3.4

Let X be a metric space. Then the metric space $B(X)$ whose metric induced by the supremum norm is complete.

Proof Let $(f_n)_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ be a Cauchy sequence in $B(X)$. Then for every $\epsilon > 0$, there exists N such that

$$\|f_n - f_m\|_\infty = \sup_{x \in X} |f_n(x) - f_m(x)| < \epsilon$$

for all $n, m > N$. In particular, for each $x \in X$, the property of supremum implies that $|f_n(x) - f_m(x)| < \epsilon$ for $n, m > N$. Thus $(f_n(x))_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \subset \mathbb{R}$ is Cauchy for each x . Since $\mathbb{R}$ is complete, $(f_n(x))_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ converges for each $x \in X$.

Now define the function $f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ by

$$f(x) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f_n(x)$$

Then fix $\epsilon > 0$, we have that

$$|f_n(x) - f(x)| < \epsilon$$

for all $n > N$ by letting $m \rightarrow \infty$ from the fact that $|f_n(x) - f_m(x)| < \epsilon$. This N does not depend on x . Fix $\epsilon = 1$, then there exists $N_1 \in \mathbb{N}$ such that

$$\begin{aligned} |f(x) - f_n(x)| &\leq |f(x) - f_{N_1}(x)| \\ &\leq 1 + |f_{N_1}(x)| \end{aligned}$$

for all $x \in X$ and $n > N_1$ thus f is bounded. This means that $f \in B(X)$ and that $\|f_n - f\|_\infty < \epsilon$ for all $n > N$. ■

Proposition 4.3.5 Any metric space X can be isometrically embedded into the complete metric space $B(X)$.

4.4 Metrizable

A common question to ask is that whether every topology can be generated from a metric.

Definition 4.4.1 (Metrizable Space) A topological space $(X, \mathcal{T})$ is said to be metrizable if there is a metric d on X that generates $\mathcal{T}$.

Proposition 4.4.2 The following are true about metrizable.

- Metrizable is a topological invariant.
- Metrizable is finitely productive.
- Metrizable is hereditary.

Proposition 4.4.3 The following are true about metric spaces.

- Every metric space is T_2, T_3 and T_4 .
- Every metric space is first countable.

Theorem 4.4.4 (Urysohn's Lemma) A topological space $(X, \mathcal{T})$ is normal if and only if for every pair of disjoint non-empty closed subsets $C, D \subseteq X$ there exists a continuous function $f : X \rightarrow [0, 1]$ such that $f(x) = 0$ for all $x \in C$ and $f(x) = 1$ for all $x \in D$.

Theorem 4.4.5 (Urysohn Metrization Theorem) Every second countable T_3 topological space is metrizable.

5 Compactness

5.1 Basic Definitions

Compactness is an important topological property that allows us to build constructive proofs. This stems from the fact that any size of open covers can be reduced to a finite number given the space is compact. One can think of compact spaces as being some sort of finite space, but instead of having a finite number of elements, it has a finite number of open sets that contain the entirety of the space. With finiteness in play we can do a lot more things such as extremums.

Definition 5.1.1 (Open Covers) Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space, and let $\mathcal{U} \subseteq \mathcal{T}$ be a collection of open subsets of X . We say that $\mathcal{U}$ is an open cover of X if

$$X = \bigcup_{U \in \mathcal{U}} U$$

If $\mathcal{V}$ is also an open cover of $(X, \mathcal{T})$, we say that $\mathcal{V}$ is a subcover of $\mathcal{U}$ if $\mathcal{V} \subseteq \mathcal{U}$.

Definition 5.1.2 (Compact Space) A topological space $(X, \mathcal{T})$ is said to be compact if every open cover of X has a finite subcover.

Below is a closed set characterization of compactness.

Theorem 5.1.3 (Finite Intersection Property) Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a collection of non-empty closed subsets of a space X such that every finite subcollection of $\mathcal{F}$ has a non-empty intersection (finite intersection property). Then X is compact if and only if the intersection of all sets from $\mathcal{F}$ is non-empty.

Proof Suppose that X is compact. Suppose for a contradiction that $\bigcap_{F \in \mathcal{F}} F = \emptyset$. Then

$$X \setminus \bigcap_{F \in \mathcal{F}} F = \bigcup_{F \in \mathcal{F}} X \setminus F = X$$

which means that $\mathcal{F}$ is an open cover of X . By compactness, there exists a finite subcover of $\mathcal{F}$, namely $F_1, \dots, F_n$ such that $\bigcup_{k=1}^n F_k = X$. But then

$$\begin{aligned} \bigcup_{k=1}^n F_k &= X \\ X \setminus \bigcup_{k=1}^n F_k &= \emptyset \\ \bigcap_{k=1}^n X \setminus F_k &= \emptyset \end{aligned}$$

which is a contradiction of the finite intersection property.

Now suppose that every finite subcollection of $\mathcal{F}$ has a non empty intersection and that $\bigcap_{F \in \mathcal{F}} F \neq \emptyset$. Suppose for a contradiction that X is not compact. Let $\{U_\alpha | \alpha \in I\}$ be an open cover of X . Since X is not compact, every finite union of the form $\bigcup_{k=1}^n U_{\alpha_k} \neq X$ for $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n \in I$ which implies that

$$\bigcap_{k=1}^n U_{\alpha_k} \neq \emptyset$$

This means that $\{X \setminus U_\alpha | \alpha \in I\}$ has the finite intersection property and thus

$$\bigcap_{\alpha \in I} X \setminus U_\alpha \neq \emptyset$$

But then taking complements of X means that $\bigcup_{\alpha \in I} U_\alpha$ does not cover X which contradicts our assumption. ■

Proposition 5.1.4

Let X, Y be topological spaces. If X, Y are compact, then $X \times Y$ is compact.

Proof Consider the product topology on $X \times Y$ given by

$$\mathcal{B} = \{U \times V \mid U \in \mathcal{T}_X, V \in \mathcal{T}_Y\}$$

Let $(x, y) \in W \subseteq T \times S$ be open, then by definition of a basis there exists $U \times V \in \mathcal{B}$ such that

$$(x, y) \in U \times V \subset W$$

Let $\mathcal{U}$ be an open cover of $X \times Y$.

Let $x \in X$. Then we can find $W_x \in \mathcal{U}$ such that $(x, y) \in W_x$. By the above, there exists $U_x \times V_x \in \mathcal{B}$ such that $(x, y) \in U_x \times V_x \subset W_x$. The sets U_x form an open cover of X , thus contains a finite subcover $U_{x_1}, \dots, U_{x_n}$. Let

$$N(y) = \bigcap_{k=1}^n V_{x_k}$$

This definition makes sense since $y \in N(y)$ is a neighbourhood of y that is open. We also have

$$X \times N(y) \subset \bigcup_{k=1}^n (U_{x_k} \times V_{x_k}) \subset \bigcup_{k=1}^n W_{x_k}$$

And thus $X \times N(y)$ has a finite subcover.

Since $\{N(y) \mid y \in Y\}$ forms an open cover, it has a finite subcover $N(y_1), \dots, N(y_m)$ that covers Y . Thus

$$X \times Y = \bigcup_{k=1}^m X \times N(y_k) \subset \bigcup_{k=1}^m \bigcup_{j=1}^n (U_{x_j} \times V_{x_k}) \subset \bigcup_{k=1}^m \bigcup_{j=1}^n W_{x_j k}$$

and $X \times Y$ has a finite subcover. ■

Theorem 5.1.5 (Tychonov's Theorem) The product of any collection of compact spaces is compact.

While products of compact spaces are compact, subspaces of compact spaces may not be compact.

Example 5.1.6

The subspace $[0, 1] \in \mathbb{R}$ is compact but the subspace $(0, 1)$ of $[0, 1]$ is not compact.

5.2 Properties of Compact Sets

Proposition 5.2.1 Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be continuous. If $K \subset X$ is compact, then $f(K)$ is compact.

Proof Let K be compact. Let $\mathcal{U}$ be an open cover of $f(K)$. Since f is continuous, for all $U \in \mathcal{U}$, $f^{-1}(U)$ are open and forms a cover of K . Since K is compact, there exists a finite subcover of K , namely $f^{-1}(U_1), \dots, f^{-1}(U_n)$.

Let $y \in f(K)$. Then $y = f(x)$ for some $x \in K$. But $x \in f^{-1}(U_k)$ for some k . Thus $y \in U_k$. Thus $U_1, \dots, U_n$ are a finite subcover of $f(K)$. ■

Proposition 5.2.2 Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a compact topological space. Let $C \subseteq X$ be a closed subset. Then C is compact.

Proof Let $\mathcal{U}$ be a cover of C by open subsets of X . Then $\mathcal{U} \cup \{X \setminus C\}$ is an open cover of X , thus has a finite subcover. This provides an open subcover of C since $X \setminus C$ is open and you can remove this element from the subcover. ■

Proposition 5.2.3 Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a Hausdorff topological space. Let $K \subseteq X$ be compact. Then K is closed.

Proof Let $a \in X \setminus K$. For each $x \in K$, there exists disjoint open sets U_x containing x and V_x containing a due to Hausdorff. Then $\{U_x | x \in K\}$ form an open cover of K , and thus has a finite subcover $U_{x_1}, \dots, U_{x_n}$ of K . Then

$$V = \bigcap_{k=1}^n V_{x_k}$$

is open and contains a and is disjoint from K . This means that $X \setminus K$ is open and thus K is closed. ■

The point of the finite subcover in the above proof is to make sure that since the U_k are covering K , V_k being disjoint from U_k means that V_k will not overlap with K .

5.3 Compactness and the Hausdorff Property

Proposition 5.3.1 Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a compact topological space. Let $(Y, \mathcal{U})$ be a Hausdorff topological space. Then any continuous bijection $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is a homeomorphism.

Proof We want to show that f^{-1} is continuous. Let $U \subset X$ be closed. Then U is compact by proposition 5.2.3. By 5.2.1, $f(U)$ is compact. Since Y is Hausdorff, $f(U)$ is closed by the above proposition. By the closed set characterization of continuous functions, f^{-1} is continuous. ■

Proposition 5.3.2 Let X, Y be spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be continuous. If $K \subseteq X$ is compact and Y is Hausdorff, then $f(K)$ is closed.

Proof Let $x \in X \setminus K$. For any $y \in K$, there exists open neighbourhoods $x \in U_y$ and $y \in V_y$ such that $U_y \cap V_y = \emptyset$ by the Hausdorff property. The collection $\{V_y | y \in Y\}$ forms an open cover of K . Since K is compact, K has a finite subcover $\{V_{y_1}, \dots, V_{y_n}\}$. Let

$$U = \bigcap_{i=1}^n U_{y_i}$$

Then U is an open neighbourhood of x and is disjoint from K . Since this is true for all $x \in X \setminus K$, we have that $X \setminus K$ is open. Hence K is closed. ■

Proposition 5.3.3 Let X be a compact space. Let Y be a Hausdorff space. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous and surjective map. Let $Z = \{f^{-1}(y) \subseteq X | y \in Y\}$ and equipped it with the quotient topology of X . Then the induced map

$$\bar{f} : Z \rightarrow Y$$

defined by $\bar{f}(f^{-1}(y)) = y$ is a homeomorphism.

Proof Let $C \subseteq X$ be closed. By 5.2.3 we conclude that C is compact in X . By 5.2.1 we have that $f(C)$ is compact in Y . By the above we conclude that $f(C)$ is closed.

Let $U = \{f^{-1}(y) | y \in T\} \subseteq Z$ be open for some subset $T \subseteq Y$. By definition of the quotient topology, the set

$$V = \{x \in X | f(x) \in T\}$$

is open in X . Then $X \setminus V$ is closed in X . By the above digression, we conclude that

$$f(X \setminus V) = Y \setminus T$$

is closed. Hence $T = \bar{f}(U)$ is open in Y .

Now let $U \subseteq Y$ be an open set. Then

$$\bar{f}^{-1}(U) = \{z \in Z \mid \bar{f}(z) \in U\} = \{f^{-1}(y) \subseteq X \mid y \in U\} = f^{-1}(U)$$

is open in X . We conclude that $\bar{f}$ is a homeomorphism because it is also clear that $\bar{f}$ is a bijection. ■

5.4 Compactness in Metric Spaces

This section is dedicated to theorems related to compactness that are unique only to metric spaces. (Notice that metric spaces are Hausdorff thus some of the theorems above are already applicable to metric spaces)

Definition 5.4.1 (Lebesgue Number) Let $\mathcal{U}$ be an open cover of a metric space X . A number $\delta > 0$ is called a Lebesgue number for $\mathcal{U}$ if for any $x \in X$ there exists $U \in \mathcal{U}$ such that $B_\delta(x) \subset U$.

Lemma 5.4.2

Let X be a metric space. Let $\mathcal{U}$ be an open cover of X . Then $\mathcal{U}$ has a Lebesgue number.

Definition 5.4.3 (Sequential Compactness)

Let X be a metric space. We say that X is sequentially compact if any sequence $(x_n)_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ in X has a convergent subsequence.

Proposition 5.4.4

Let X be a metric space. Then X is compact if and only if X is sequentially compact.

Proposition 5.4.5

Let M be a metric space. Let $U \subseteq M$ be a subspace. If U is compact, then U is closed and bounded.

Proof Let $a \in X$. Let $x \in K$. Then $x \in B_r(a)$ for all $r > d(a, x)$. Thus K is covered by the collection of open balls $B_r(a)$. Thus it has a finite subcover $B_{r_1}(a), \dots, B_{r_n}(a)$. Thus

$$K \subset \bigcup_{k=1}^n B_{r_k}(a) = B_{\max\{r_1, \dots, r_n\}}(a)$$

and we are done. ■

Proposition 5.4.6

Let X be metric space. If X is compact, then the following are true.

- X is complete.
- Let Y be a metric space. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous function. Then f is uniformly continuous.

Proof

Suppose that $(x_n)_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ is a Cauchy sequence in a compact metric space X . Then X being sequentially compact means that there exists a subsequence of $(x_n)_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ such that it converges in X . But then clearly

$$d(x_n, x) \leq d(x_n, x_{n_k}) + d(x_{n_k}, x)$$

implies that $x_n \rightarrow x$ since in the inequality, the first part of the sum corresponds to the sequence being Cauchy and thus tends to 0, while the latter part corresponds to the subsequence being convergent and thus tends to 0. ■

5.5 Compactness in $\mathbb{R}^n$

We arrive at an important characterization of compact sets in $\mathbb{R}^n$.

Theorem 5.5.1 (Heine-Borel Theorem) A subset of $\mathbb{R}^n$ is compact if and only if it is closed and bounded.

Proof Let K be a compact subset of $\mathbb{R}^n$. K is closed by proposition 5.2.5 and K is bounded by proposition 5.4.6.

Let K be a closed and bounded subset of $\mathbb{R}^n$. If K is bounded then $K \subset [-r, r]^n$ for some $r > 0$. I claim that $[-r, r]^n$ is compact. Once it is compact, applying 5.2.3 to the closed subset K of $[-r, r]^n$, we have that K is compact.

Let $(x_n)_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ be a sequence in $[-r, r]$ by bolzano weierstrass it has a convergent subsequence. Thus $[-r, r]$ is sequentially compact and thus compact. Using the productivity of compact metric spaces, we have that $[-r, r]^n$ is compact thus we are done. ■

This concludes the Bolzano weierstrass theorem for $\mathbb{R}^n$ by considering sequential compactness. We also have another important theorem upcoming but we need another theorem prior to it.

Theorem 5.5.2 Let $f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a continuous function from a non empty compact space X to $\mathbb{R}$. Then f is bounded and attains its bounds.

Proof Since X is compact and f is continuous, $f(X) \subset \mathbb{R}$ is compact. By the Heine-Borel theorem, $f(X)$ is closed and bounded. But every closed and bounded subset of $\mathbb{R}$ contains its supremum and infimum. Thus f is bounded and attains its bounds. ■

Theorem 5.5.3 All norms on $\mathbb{R}^n$ are equivalent. This means that norms on $\mathbb{R}^n$ induce the same topology, the standard topology.

Proof Let $\|\cdot\|$ be an arbitrary norm on $\mathbb{R}^n$. We show that it is equivalent to $\|\cdot\|_2$. Let $\{e_1, \dots, e_n\}$ be an orthonormal basis of $\mathbb{R}^n$. Then for any $x \in \mathbb{R}^n$, we have $x = \sum_{k=1}^n x_k e_k$. We have that

$$\begin{aligned} \|x\| &= \left\| \sum_{k=1}^n x_k e_k \right\| \\ &\leq \sum_{k=1}^n |x_k| \|e_k\| \\ &\leq \left(\sum_{k=1}^n |x_k|^2 \right)^{\frac{1}{2}} \left(\sum_{k=1}^n \|e_k\|^2 \right)^{\frac{1}{2}} \\ &= \left(\sum_{k=1}^n \|e_k\|^2 \right)^{\frac{1}{2}} \|x\|_2 \end{aligned}$$

Thus we have that $\|x\| \leq c_2 \|x\|_2$.

Now we have that $\|x - y\| \leq c_2 \|x - y\|_2$ for $x, y \in \mathbb{R}^n$. Define a map $f : (\mathbb{R}^n, \|\cdot\|_2) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ by $f(x) = \|x\|$. The above criteria means that f is continuous by choosing $\delta < \epsilon$. Since $\partial B_1(0)$ with the standard norm is a closed and bounded subset of $\mathbb{R}^n$, it is compact by the Heine-Borel theorem. From the above theorem, $f(\partial B_1(0))$ is bounded and attains its bounds. This means that $0 \leq c_1 < f(\partial B_1(0))$ for some c_1 . But $c_1 \neq 0$ since if it is 0, then there exists $x \in \partial B_1(0)$ such that $\|x\|_2 = 0$.

This means that $\|x\|_2 = 1$ implies $\|x\| \geq c_1$. Let $y \in \mathbb{R}^n$ be arbitrary. Then since $\left\| \frac{y}{\|y\|_2} \right\| = 1$, we have that

$$\left\| \frac{y}{\|y\|_2} \right\| \geq c_1$$

and $\|y\| \geq c_1 \|y\|_2$. Since this y is arbitrary, we are done. ■

5.6 Local Compactness

Definition 5.6.1

Let X be a space. We say that X is locally compact if for all $x \in X$, there exists $U \subseteq X$ such that $x \in U$ and U is compact.

Lemma 5.6.2

Let X be a space. If X is compact, then X is locally compact.

Proposition 5.6.3

Let X be a space. Let $Y \subseteq X$ be a subspace. If X is locally compact, then Y is locally compact.

Proposition 5.6.4

Let X, Y be spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous function. Suppose that the following are true.

- X is locally compact.
- $U \subseteq X$ is open if and only if $f(U)$ is open.
- f is surjective.

Then Y is locally compact.

Proposition 5.6.5

Let $\{X_i \mid i \in I\}$ be a collection of spaces. Then $\prod_{i \in I} X_i$ is locally compact if and only if X_i is locally compact for all $i \in I$ and all but finitely many X_i are compact.

Proposition 5.6.6

Let X be a space. Let $Y \subseteq X$ be an open subspace. If X is locally compact and Hausdorff, then Y is locally compact.

5.7 Proper and Closed Maps

Definition 5.7.1 (Proper Maps)

Let X, Y be spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous function. We say that f is proper if for every compact subset $U \subseteq Y$, we have $f^{-1}(U)$ is compact.

Definition 5.7.2 (Closed Maps)

Let X, Y be spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous function. We say that f is closed if for all closed subset $U \subseteq X$, we have $f(U)$ is closed.

Proposition 5.7.3

Let X, Y be spaces. Suppose that X and Y are Hausdorff and Y is locally compact. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous function. Then the following are equivalent.

- f is proper.
- For any space Z , the map $f \times \text{id}_Z : X \times Z \rightarrow Y \times Z$ is a closed map.
- f is a closed map and $f^{-1}(y)$ is compact for all $y \in Y$.

6 Connectedness

6.1 Basic Definitions

Definition 6.1.1 (Connected Space)

Let X be a topological space. We say that X is disconnected if there exists non-empty open subsets $A, B \subseteq X$ such that the following are true.

- $A \cap B = \emptyset$.
- $A \cup B = X$.

We say that X is connected if X is not disconnected.

Proposition 6.1.2

Let X be a topological space. Then the following are equivalent.

- X is connected.
- There exists non-empty closed subsets $A, B \subseteq X$ such that $A \cap B = \emptyset$ and $A \cup B = X$.
- If $A \subseteq X$ is a nonempty subset of X that is both open and closed, then $A = X$.
- If $f : X \rightarrow \{0, 1\}$ is a continuous function where the codomain has the discrete topology, then f is constant.

Proof ■

6.2 Properties of Connectedness

Proposition 6.2.1

Let X, Y be topological spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous function. If X is connected, then $f(X)$ is connected.

Proof Suppose for a contradiction that $f(X)$ is disconnected. Suppose that it is disconnected by A, B . Then $f^{-1}(A)$ and $f^{-1}(B)$ is clearly disjoint since A and B are disjoint. Since $A \cup B = f(X)$, we must also have $f^{-1}(A) \cup f^{-1}(B) = X$. By continuity, $f^{-1}(A)$ and $f^{-1}(B)$ are open. Thus $f(X)$ is disconnected, a contradiction. ■

Proposition 6.2.2 Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space. Let $\{C_i | i \in I\}$ is a non-empty connected subsets of X with the property that $\bigcap_{i \in I} C_i \neq \emptyset$. Then $\bigcup_{i \in I} C_i$ is connected.

Proof Suppose that $x \in \bigcap_{i \in I} C_i$. Then $x \in C_i$ for all i . Let f be a continuous function from X to $\{0, 1\}$. WLOG take $f(x) = 0$. Then since each C_i is connected, every $y \in C_i$ maps to 0. Then every $y \in \bigcup_{i \in I} C_i$ maps to 0 and thus f is constant and we are done. ■

The following lemma is slightly different from the one above since we simply require the closure to have nonempty intersection. The two sets can be touching each other instead of intersecting each other to be connected.

Lemma 6.2.3 Suppose that C_1, C_2 are connected subsets of a topological space X and $\overline{C_1} \cap C_2 \neq \emptyset$. Then $C_1 \cup C_2$ is connected.

Proof Suppose that $f : C_1 \cup C_2 \rightarrow \{0, 1\}$ is continuous. WLOG take $f(C_1) = \{0\}$. Suppose for a contradiction that $f(C_2) = \{1\}$. Then $f^{-1}(1)$ is open thus there exists some $U \in \mathcal{T}$ such that $f^{-1}(1) = U \cap (C_1 \cup C_2)$. Now let $x \in \overline{C_1} \cap C_2$. But $x \in C_2$ means that $f(x) = 1$ thus $x \in U \cap (C_1 \cup C_2)$ and $x \in U$. Then clearly

$$U \cap C_1 \neq \emptyset$$

since $x \in \overline{C_1} \cup C_2$.

But $C_1 \subseteq C_1 \cup C_2$ thus we have

$$\begin{aligned} U \cap (C_1 \cup C_2) \cap C_1 &\neq \emptyset \\ f^{-1}(1) \cap C_1 &\neq \emptyset \end{aligned}$$

This is a contradiction since $f(C_1) = \{0\}$ thus we are done. ■

Theorem 6.2.4 Let C and $\{C_i | i \in I\}$ be connected subsets of a topological space X and $C_i \cap \overline{C} \neq \emptyset$ for each i . Then

$$C \cup \bigcup_{i \in I} C_i$$

is connected.

Proof Apply the above lemma to $C \cup C_i$. This is the possible since $C_i \cap \overline{C} \neq \emptyset$. Thus each $C \cup C_i$ is connected. Trivially each pair $(C \cup C_i) \cap (C \cup C_j)$ is nonempty since it contains C . Thus we can apply the proposition above the lemma and we are done. ■

This theorem is slightly different then the one above since there is a central connected subset linking every other connected subset while in the first one, we simply require pairwise connectedness.

Corollary 6.2.5 If $C \subset X$ is a connected subset of a topological space X then so is any set K where $C \subseteq K \subseteq \overline{C}$.

Proof Any K between C and $\overline{C}$ must contain some but not all of the boundary of C . Then we can apply the above theorem and we are done. ■

Example 6.2.6

The space $\mathbb{R}$ is connected but the subspace $[0, 1] \cup [2, 3]$ is not connected. Thus connectedness is not hereditary.

Proposition 6.2.7

Let $\{X_i | i \in I\}$ be a family of connected topological spaces. Then $\prod_{i \in I} X_i$ is connected.

Definition 6.2.8 (Connected Components)

Let X be a space. Let $U \subseteq X$ be a subset. We say that U is a connected component of X if the following are true.

- U is connected.
- If $V \subseteq X$ is connected and $U \subseteq V$, then $V = U$.

Proposition 6.2.9

Let X be a space. Then the set of connected components of X partitions X .

Proposition 6.2.10

Let X be a space. Let C be a connected component of X . Then the following are true.

- C is closed.
- If X has finitely many connected components, then C is open.

6.3 Totally Disconnected

Definition 6.3.1 (Totally Disconnected)

Let X be a space. We say that X is totally disconnected if every connected component of X is a one point set.

Example 6.3.2

If X is a discrete space, then X is totally disconnected.

The converse of the above is not true in general.

Proposition 6.3.3

Let X be a space. Let $Y \subseteq X$ be a subspace. If X is totally disconnected, then Y is totally disconnected.

Proposition 6.3.4

Let $\{X_i \mid i \in I\}$ be a collection of spaces. Then $\prod_{i \in I} X_i$ is totally disconnected if and only if X_i is totally disconnected for all $i \in I$.

6.4 Path Connectedness**Definition 6.4.1** (Paths in a Topological Space)

Let X be a topological space. A path in X is a continuous function $\gamma : [0, 1] \rightarrow X$.

Definition 6.4.2 (Path Connectedness)

Let X be a topological space. We say that X is path connected if for all $x, y \in X$, there exists a path $\gamma : [0, 1] \rightarrow X$ such that $\gamma(0) = x$ and $\gamma(1) = y$.

Proposition 6.4.3 Every path connected space is connected.

Proof Let $u \in X$. Consider any $v \in X$. Then there exists a path from u to v . Thus the image of the path is connected since it is the continuous image of $[0, 1]$. Then $X = \{u\} \cup \bigcup_{v \in X} C_v$ and each C_v contains u thus X is connected. ■

6.5 Connectedness on $\mathbb{R}^n$ **Proposition 6.5.1**

Let $U \subseteq \mathbb{R}$ be a subspace. Then U is connected if and only if U is an interval.

Proposition 6.5.2 A subset U of $\mathbb{R}$ is open if and only if it is the disjoint union of countably many open intervals.